

RESEARCH ON FACTORS INFLUENCING TRUST RECOVERY AND CONTINUANCE PURCHASE INTENTION AFTER A PRODUCT-NOT-AS-DESCRIBED INCIDENT ON TIKTOK SHOP

Author: Đồng Thành Đạt

Từ khóa: TikTok Shop; SNAD; niềm tin phục hồi; trả hàng - hoàn tiền; ý định tiếp tục mua; PLS-SEM. Keywords: TikTok Shop; SNAD; trust recovery; return-refund process; continuance purchase intention; PLS-SEM	TÓM TẮT Mục tiêu của nghiên cứu là xác định cách trải nghiệm sau sự cố sản phẩm không đúng mô tả trên TikTok Shop chuyển thành niềm tin phục hồi và ý định tiếp tục mua. Nghiên cứu sử dụng dữ liệu của 1.087 người mua đã hoàn tất quy trình trả hàng hoặc hoàn tiền, kết hợp Cronbach's Alpha, EFA, PLS-SEM cùng các kiểm tra dự báo và độ bền. Kết quả cho thấy đóng một yếu cầu hậu mãi chưa đồng nghĩa phục hồi được quan hệ với khách hàng. Người mua không chỉ nhìn vào việc có được hoàn tiền hay không; họ đồng thời ghi nhận mức độ lời hứa ban đầu bị phá vỡ, công sức phải bỏ ra để chứng minh vấn đề, sự tương xứng của kết quả và mức rõ ràng của thông tin xử lý. Niềm tin phục hồi là cơ chế biến trải nghiệm vừa qua thành dự đoán về lần mua kế tiếp, nhưng sai lệch sản phẩm vẫn để lại một phần ảnh hưởng mà hậu mãi không thể xóa hết. Rủi ro giảm mua vì vậy gắn với trạng thái của sự cố nhiều hơn chân dung khách hàng. Hàm ý quản trị là TikTok Shop cần ngăn sai lệch từ trước mua, đồng thời thiết kế phục hồi ít ma sát, công bằng và đủ rõ để khách hàng cảm thấy rủi ro của lần mua tiếp theo có thể dự đoán và kiểm soát. ABSTRACT The objective of this study is to determine how post-incident experiences involving products that do not match their descriptions on TikTok Shop translate into restored trust and continued purchase intention. The study uses data from 1,087 buyers who completed a return or refund process, combining Cronbach's Alpha, exploratory factor analysis (EFA), PLS-SEM, and predictive and robustness assessments. The findings show that closing an after-sales request does not necessarily mean that the customer relationship has been restored. Buyers consider more than whether they ultimately receive a refund; they also evaluate the extent to which the original promise was violated, the effort required to prove the problem, the fairness and proportionality of the outcome, and the clarity of information throughout the resolution process. Restored trust serves as the mechanism through which the recent experience is translated into expectations about the next purchase, although product discrepancies still leave a residual effect that after-sales recovery cannot fully eliminate. The risk of reduced purchasing is therefore more closely associated with the nature and status of the incident than with the customer's demographic profile. From a managerial perspective, TikTok Shop should prevent product discrepancies before purchase while also designing recovery processes that are low-friction, fair, and sufficiently transparent for customers to perceive the risks of their next purchase as predictable and manageable.
--	--

1. INTRODUCTION

Vietnamese e-commerce has entered a stage in which even a small after-sales problem can spread into a significant retention cost. The Ministry of Industry and Trade (2025) recorded a market size exceeding USD 25 billion in 2024 and continuing to grow by about 20%; Metric (2026) showed that TikTok Shop accounted for 41,31% of the sales of the four major platforms in 2025, while the total transaction value of this group of platforms reached VND 429,7 trillion. As order volume grows rapidly, the quality of the experience after a failed transaction is no longer a secondary handling step. It determines whether a failure is closed at the order level or continues to reduce the value of the customer relationship.

This risk is more apparent on TikTok Shop because the journey of discovery, persuasion, and purchase often occurs continuously within short videos or livestreams. Wang et al. (2022) showed that livestreaming changes purchase decisions through information, entertainment, and the role of the host; as a result, expectations can be formed very quickly before buyers fully verify product attributes. When the product actually received differs significantly from the images, description, design, size, function, or demonstration content, buyers face not only an unsuitable item but must also reassess the trustworthiness of the information source that led them to the purchase decision.

TikTok Shop classifies this group of situations as Significantly Not As Described (SNAD) and has a separate process for return, refund, and dispute requests (TikTok Shop

Academy, 2024; 2026). Consumer-protection data in Vietnam also show that goods of incorrect quality, misleading advertising, inadequate exchanges/returns, and inadequate compensation have appeared in e-commerce complaints. The issue therefore does not stop at “whether the money can be refunded.” A request may be procedurally closed while the buyer still pays additional costs in time, effort to prove the problem, uncertainty while waiting, and perceived risk for the next transaction.

The research gap becomes clearer when compared with recent Vietnamese studies. Nguyễn Lan, Nguyễn Thu Hà, and Tân Thị Khánh Phương (2021) surveyed 597 online buyers and showed that information quality, delivery, convenience, website usability, and trust have different relationships with satisfaction and repurchase intention, but the unit of analysis remained the general shopping experience. Hoàng Văn Tình and Đoàn Thanh Hải (2024) showed that trust is an important mediating mechanism between livestream characteristics and impulse buying; Lê Trọng Thảo Phương (2024) identified trust and perceived risk among six factors associated with purchase intention on TikTok Shop in Ho Chi Minh City. These studies explain well the stage in which the purchase decision is formed, but do not examine deeply how trust is rebuilt after a failed transaction. On the post-purchase side, Tạ Kim Phúc (2025) shifted the focus to post-purchase regret and return intention in livestream commerce; Đỗ Anh Đức et al. (2025) directly examined reverse logistics in Vietnam and showed that information quality, convenience, and recovery measures are associated with satisfaction or trust, while satisfaction and trust bridge the path to repurchase intention. Lê Huyền Trang, Phạm Thị Vân Anh, and Nguyễn Thị Thùy Trang (2025) further showed that satisfaction

mediates the relationship between trust and repurchase intention in Vietnamese e-commerce. Nevertheless, a model is still lacking that begins with an SNAD incident that has occurred on TikTok Shop and simultaneously separates four pieces of evidence customers use to evaluate the next transaction: how far the product deviated, how much effort the process required, whether the refund outcome was proportionate, and whether the handling decision was clear enough to verify. This gap matters because a case may have been closed and the money may have been refunded, while the risk the customer assigns to the next order remains intact.

From that gap, the study “Factors influencing trust recovery and continuance purchase intention after a product-not-as-described incident on TikTok Shop” was conducted with the unit of analysis being an SNAD incident that had already received an after-sales decision. The study focuses on four actionable signals: Product Description Discrepancy (PDD), Return-Refund Process Friction (RPF), Refund Outcome Fairness (RFO), and Resolution Information Transparency (RIT); Platform Recovery Trust in TikTok Shop (PRT) is placed between the recovery experience and Continuance Purchase Intention (CPI). This structure allows simultaneous assessment of the damage that appears before after-sales recovery and the value that the recovery mechanism can recreate after the incident occurs.

The objective of the study is to determine the degree of association of the four factors above with PRT, test the role of PRT with respect to CPI, examine whether PDD remains directly associated with CPI, and assess the stability of the main relationships when incident order value, purchase frequency, after-sales experience, length of TikTok Shop use, and product category are taken into account. The

results are used to identify where priority should be given to preventing discrepancies, reducing customer effort, improving the proportionality of recovery, and making the handling process more predictable.

2. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

2.1 Theoretical basis and research model

Oliver (1980) laid the foundation for expectation-disconfirmation theory: buyers do not evaluate a transaction only by product attributes, but by the gap between what they were led to expect before purchase and what they actually received. In this model, Product Description Discrepancy (PDD) represents that gap. The greater the discrepancy, the stronger the evidence that the pre-transaction promise was not fulfilled; therefore, PDD is expected to be negatively associated with Platform Recovery Trust (PRT) and may also remain directly negatively associated with Continuance Purchase Intention (CPI).

Once failure has occurred, the question shifts from “how wrong was the product” to “how does the platform fix the problem.” Tax et al. (1998) showed that complaint experiences are evaluated through outcome, procedural, and interactional justice; Smith, Bolton, and Wagner (1999) emphasized that recovery must be proportionate to the type and magnitude of the failure; Maxham and Netemeyer (2002) linked perceived fairness after complaints with relationship evaluations and purchase intentions. In online shopping, Kuo and Wu (2012) further showed that dimensions of recovery justice are associated with post-recovery states and post-purchase intentions. From this mechanism, Return-Refund Process Friction (RPF) is expected to be negatively associated with PRT, while Refund Outcome Fairness (RFO) and Resolution Information Transparency (RIT) are expected to be positively associated with PRT.

Recent studies in Vietnam clarify why trust needs to be positioned between platform experience and continuance behavior. Nguyễn Lan, Nguyễn Thu Hà, and Tân Thị Khánh Phương (2021) showed that in online shopping, information quality, delivery, convenience, usability, and trust are associated with satisfaction or repurchase intention. Hoàng Văn Tình and Đoàn Thanh Hải (2024) confirmed trust as a mediator in livestream shopping behavior, while Lê Trọng Thảo Phương (2024) found that trust and perceived risk are two of the factors associated with TikTok Shop purchase intention. These studies primarily look at customers before or at the time of purchase. At the post-purchase stage, Đỗ Anh Đức et al. (2025) showed that in Vietnamese e-commerce reverse logistics, information quality and convenience increase satisfaction, while recovery measures and information quality strengthen trust; both satisfaction and trust mediate the path to repurchase intention. Lê Huyền Trang, Phạm Thị Vân Anh, and Nguyễn Thị Thùy Trang (2025) also showed that satisfaction is the mediating link between trust and repurchase intention. Tạ Kim Phúc (2025) moved closer to the livestream context by studying the chain of trust – impulse buying – regret – return intention. The Vietnamese evidence chain has therefore touched trust, returns, and repurchase, but has not separated a specific SNAD incident on TikTok Shop into four layers—PDD, RPF, RFO, and RIT—to test the relationship-recovery mechanism after the case has received a final decision.

From the basis above, the model proposes six direct hypotheses: H1, PDD → PRT (-); H2, RPF → PRT (-); H3, RFO → PRT (+); H4, RIT → PRT (+); H5, PRT → CPI (+); H6, PDD → CPI (-). The four PDD/RPF/RFO/RIT → PRT → CPI effects are tested as mediating mechanisms, without creating additional hypothesis codes merely to make the model

longer. Five background variables—incident order value, purchase frequency, experience with after-sales requests, length of TikTok Shop use, and product category—are used for robustness checks. They are not assumed to be causes of PRT or CPI; their function is to test whether the main relationships remain stable when these observed differences are taken into account. The proposed research model is as follows:

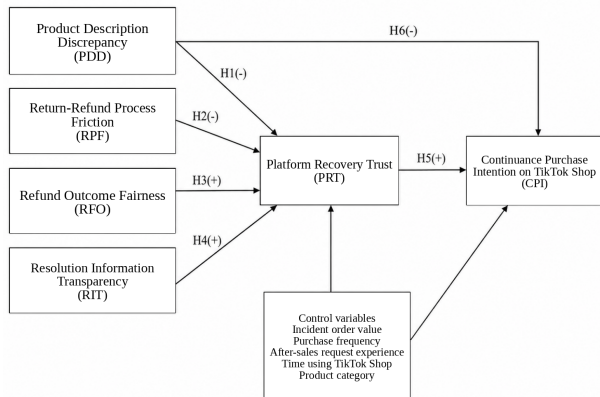


Figure 1: Proposed research model

2.2 Analysis method

The analysis is implemented in sequence from scale testing to the structural model. Step 1 uses Cronbach's Alpha and corrected item-total correlation (CITC) to assess internal consistency. For reflective scales, an Alpha range of approximately 0,70-0,95 is regarded as appropriate; excessively high values require checking for possible content duplication among items (Hair et al., 2022). CITC of 0,30 or above is used as the screening threshold; an item is removed only when statistical evidence is accompanied by a content-based reason, rather than deleting a variable merely to increase Alpha.

Step 2 uses exploratory factor analysis (EFA) with Principal Component Analysis and Varimax rotation to examine the empirical structure of the observed variables. KMO must be greater than 0,50 for the data to be sufficiently suitable for factor analysis; Kaiser (1974) regards values approaching 1 as evidence of a higher level of adequacy. The

Bartlett test needs Sig. < 0,05. Absolute factor loadings from 0,50 are prioritized in interpretation, while cross-loadings, Eigenvalue, extracted variance, and theoretical structure must be considered together. The PDD-RPF-RFO-RIT block is extracted according to an exploratory structure; PRT-CPI is additionally checked using a pre-specified two-factor solution as a theory-based diagnostic. If the second factor does not satisfy the Kaiser criterion or cross-loadings remain large, the two-factor solution is not used alone to assert discriminant validity.

Step 3 evaluates the measurement model and structural model using PLS-SEM. Hair et al. (2022) recommend outer loadings of approximately 0,708 or above; Cronbach's Alpha, rho_A, and Composite Reliability in the 0,70-0,95 range; Average Variance Extracted (AVE) from 0,50; inner VIF preferably below 3 and not exceeding 5. Discriminant validity is checked using HTMT, for which Henseler, Ringle, and Sarstedt (2015) propose a threshold of 0,85 for the strict criterion and 0,90 when constructs are close. Paths H1-H6 are estimated using PLS-SEM Mode A; Bootstrap with 5.000 samples provides β , standard error, t, p, and 95% confidence intervals. A mediating effect is supported when the Bootstrap confidence interval of the indirect effect does not contain 0 (Nitzl, Roldan, and Cepeda, 2016).

Step 4 evaluates perception states and group differences. A One-Sample T-Test uses the benchmark of 3, the neutral midpoint of the 5-point Likert scale, to answer a symmetrical question for both types of constructs: whether PDD and RPF are above the neutral state in the adverse direction; and whether RFO, RIT, PRT, and CPI rise above the neutral state in the positive direction. The benchmark of 3 is therefore a diagnostic point, not a managerial target. Group analysis uses ANOVA when the variance assumption is acceptable; if Levene

indicates unequal variances, Welch ANOVA and Games-Howell are preferred. Eta-squared (η^2) is reported together with the p-value to distinguish statistical significance from the substantive magnitude of differences.

Step 5 adds the prediction and robustness layers. Logistic Regression is used as the baseline model and compared with Random Forest, XGBoost, LightGBM, MLP, and Stacking using cross-validation; SHAP describes the contribution of each signal to prediction, while K-Means summarizes experience states. Models with control variables, PSM, DML, quantile regression, and Shapley decomposition are used for different robustness questions. PSM specifically dichotomizes RFO at the median: $T=1$ when RFO is greater than the median and $T=0$ when RFO is less than or equal to the median; 1:1 nearest-neighbor matching is restricted by a caliper of 0,2 standard deviations of the logit propensity, and PRT is the outcome. These techniques do not replace one another and do not turn cross-sectional data into causal evidence: PSM only balances observed variables, SHAP/Shapley allocates predictive or explanatory power, while structural coefficients are interpreted as conditional relationships consistent with the model and data.

2.3 Data collection method

The study uses an online cross-sectional survey and purposive sampling combined with soft quotas because the target population is not all TikTok Shop buyers, but those who have experienced an eligible SNAD incident. Respondents must be 18 years old or above, have purchased on TikTok Shop within the most recent six months, have directly received a product that differed significantly from the selling content, have submitted a return or refund request, and have received a final decision. If there were multiple incidents,

respondents evaluate only the most recent one. Anchoring the questionnaire to a specific event helps PDD, RPF, RFO, RIT, PRT, and CPI refer to the same experience rather than mixing multiple different orders.

The minimum sample size was determined in advance through power analysis for the equation with four direct predictors of PRT. With $\alpha=0,05$, target power of 0,95, and a small effect size $f^2=0,02$ according to Cohen's (1988) convention, the calculation using G*Power requires at least 934 valid observations; Faul et al. (2009) provide the methodological basis for power analysis using G*Power. After screening and cleaning, 1.087 valid records were included in the analysis, exceeding the established minimum threshold. Because there is no complete list of eligible buyers from TikTok Shop, the sample is not treated as a probability sample and the results are not used to estimate the SNAD rate among all buyers.

The questionnaire consists of 24 observed variables for six constructs, with four items per construct, and uses a 5-point Likert scale from 1 "Strongly disagree" to 5 "Strongly agree." Control variables are measured at the background-data level and include incident order value, purchase frequency before the incident, refund-request experience, length of TikTok Shop use, and product category. The data are checked for screening conditions, duplicate responses, attention-check questions, logical contradictions, and abnormal response patterns before analysis; record exclusion is performed according to data-quality rules, not according to whether model coefficients increase or decrease.

3. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

3.1 Survey sample characteristics

Table 1: Characteristics of the TikTok Shop buyer survey sample

Characteristic	Sample n=1087		
	Frequency	Percentage %	% Cumulative
Age group			
18–22 years old	78	7,2	7,2
23–27 years old	369	33,9	41,1
28–35 years old	320	29,4	70,6
36–45 years old	231	21,3	91,8
Over 45 years old	89	8,2	100,0
Product category in which the incident occurred			
Fashion	253	23,3	23,3
Cosmetics	202	18,6	41,9
Household goods	196	18,0	59,9
Electronics	169	15,5	75,4
Food	166	15,3	90,7
Other	101	9,3	100,0
Incident order value			
Under VND 100.000	193	17,8	17,8
VND 100.000–300.000	202	18,6	36,3
VND 300.000–500.000	269	24,7	61,1
VND 500.000–1.000.000	237	21,8	82,9
Over VND 1.000.000	186	17,1	100,0
After-sales request outcome			
Rejected	291	26,8	26,8
Partial refund	244	22,4	49,2
Full refund	294	27,0	76,3
Successful exchange/return	258	23,7	100,0
Processing time			
1–2 days	276	25,4	25,4
3–5 days	296	27,2	52,6
6–10 days	295	27,1	79,8
Over 10 days	220	20,2	100,0
Length of TikTok Shop use			
Under 3 months	152	14,0	14,0
3–6 months	218	20,1	34,0
7–12 months	263	24,2	58,2
1–2 years	259	23,8	82,1
Over 2 years	195	17,9	100,0

Source: Descriptive statistics from the research data, $n = 1.087$, year 2026.

The sample is not concentrated in a single product category or price level. Fashion accounts for the largest share but only 23,3%; the five order-value groups range from 17,1–24,7%; the four after-sales outcomes range from 22,4–27,0%. This dispersion matters because the subsequent coefficients do not merely reflect a group of “cheap orders,” “fashion products,” or “fully refunded” cases. The sample covers both failure and recovery, from rejection to successful exchange/return

and from 1–2 days of processing to more than 10 days.

The dispersion of the sample makes it possible to test whether trust and continuance purchase intention truly differ by order value, product category, or handling state. The background variables are therefore retained for group-difference and robustness checks in later sections rather than being assumed to be important causes merely because they are easy to observe. This sequence separates sample description from conclusion: Table 1 only shows which types of incidents the study covered; the magnitude of differences between groups is determined by separate statistical tests.

3.2 Scale reliability test results

Reliability is tested at the individual-item level before proceeding to EFA. Cronbach’s Alpha for the six scales ranges from 0,912–0,928, above the 0,70 threshold but not exceeding the 0,95 range that warrants caution about content duplication. Corrected item-total correlation (CITC) ranges from 0,783–0,844, clearly above the screening threshold of 0,30 established in the method. More importantly, Alpha if each item is deleted is lower than the Alpha of the corresponding scale, so no item is removed merely to improve internal consistency.

Table 2: Scale reliability test results

Alpha	Variable	Item-total c orrelation	Alpha if i tem deleted
PDD (0,914)	PDD1	0,814	0,884
	PDD2	0,809	0,886
	PDD3	0,803	0,888
	PDD4	0,785	0,894
RPF (0,912)	RPF1	0,795	0,887
	RPF2	0,805	0,884
	RPF3	0,804	0,884
	RPF4	0,793	0,888
RFO (0,913)	RFO1	0,817	0,882
	RFO2	0,799	0,889
	RFO3	0,810	0,885
	RFO4	0,783	0,894
RIT (0,915)	RIT1	0,810	0,889
	RIT2	0,801	0,892
	RIT3	0,790	0,896
	RIT4	0,825	0,884
PRT (0,928)	PRT1	0,844	0,902
	PRT2	0,826	0,907
	PRT3	0,815	0,911
	PRT4	0,839	0,903

Alpha	Variable	Item-total correlation	Alpha if item deleted
CPI (0,925)	CPI1	0,829	0,902
	CPI2	0,822	0,904
	CPI3	0,814	0,907
	CPI4	0,839	0,898

Source: Cronbach's Alpha test results from the research data, $n = 1.087$, year 2026.

Table 2 shows that the decision to retain variables does not depend on a single overall Alpha index. PDD4 and RFO4 have the lowest CITC values within their respective scales but still reach 0,785 and 0,783; if these two items were removed, Alpha would fall to only 0,894 instead of 0,914 and 0,913. At the other end, PRT has an Alpha of 0,928 with CITC of 0,815-0,844, but Alpha if each item is deleted is still below 0,928. Therefore, all 24 observed variables are retained for the EFA step. High reliability at this step only confirms that the items move together; convergent validity and discriminant validity still have to be checked separately in the next section.

3.3 Factor analysis and measurement-model results

KMO for all 24 variables reaches 0,949. When the four explanatory variables PDD-RPF-RFO-RIT are separated, KMO reaches 0,852 and Bartlett $\chi^2=11.927,960$ with $df=120$, $p<0,001$, indicating that the correlation matrix is suitable for EFA. The four-factor solution for these 16 variables has Eigenvalues of 3,610; 3,183; 3,015; and 2,912, respectively, and explains a cumulative 79,501% of the variance. Primary loadings are in the 0,879-0,903 range, while cross-loadings are all very small, so the four item groups PDD, RPF, RFO, and RIT are clearly separated in the exploratory step.

Table 3: Rotated factor matrix analysis results for the four explanatory variables

Variable	F1	F2	F3	F4
RIT4	0,903	-0,032	0,017	-0,033
RIT1	0,896	-0,006	0,008	-0,025
RIT2	0,890	0,005	0,023	-0,012
RIT3	0,880	-0,026	0,004	-0,068
PDD1	-0,013	0,898	-0,020	-0,008
PDD2	-0,037	0,894	-0,032	0,009
PDD3	-0,024	0,891	-0,027	0,014
PDD4	0,016	0,880	-0,023	0,024
RFO1	0,005	-0,049	0,899	-0,010

Variable	F1	F2	F3	F4
RFO3	0,041	-0,022	0,895	-0,027
RFO2	0,037	-0,028	0,888	-0,011
RFO4	-0,031	-0,001	0,879	-0,033
RPF2	-0,010	0,045	-0,015	0,893
RPF3	-0,033	0,022	-0,040	0,891
RPF1	-0,047	-0,008	-0,021	0,885
RPF4	-0,048	-0,020	-0,005	0,885
Eigen.	3,610	3,183	3,015	2,912
% Var.	22,562	19,893	18,844	18,203
Alpha	0,915	0,914	0,913	0,912

KMO = 0,852; Sig. Bartlett < 0,001; Cumulative = 79,501%

Source: EFA factor-analysis results from the research data, $n = 1.087$, year 2026.

The EFA structure of the four explanatory variables also preserves the content boundaries established before analysis: RPF focuses on the effort and time buyers must expend, RIT focuses on how well they understand the status, evidence, and basis for handling, while RFO reflects the proportionality of the outcome. The fact that these three after-sales aspects separate into distinct factors helps reduce the risk of combining every post-incident problem under the general label “customer service.”

The PRT-CPI block requires greater caution. KMO reaches 0,947; Bartlett $\chi^2=7.897,709$ with $df=28$, $p<0,001$. The two-factor solution fixed according to the theoretical structure explains 81,984% of the variance, of which F1 accounts for 74,333% and F2 accounts for 7,651%. However, the Eigenvalue of F2 reaches only 0,612, below the Kaiser >1 criterion; at the same time, CPI items still have absolute cross-loadings of 0,502-0,581 on F1. According to the Kaiser criterion, the exploratory data lean toward one general factor rather than two cleanly separated factors. Therefore, the two-factor solution is retained only as a theory-based diagnostic, not as independent evidence confirming that PRT and CPI have strong discriminant validity.

Table 4: Rotated factor matrix analysis results for PRT and CPI

Variable	F1	F2
PRT1	-0,872	0,276
PRT4	-0,872	0,270
PRT2	-0,862	0,272
PRT3	-0,844	0,295
CPI2	-0,502	0,756
CPI3	-0,517	0,735

Variable	F1	F2
CPI1	-0,560	0,709
CPI4	-0,581	0,698
Eigen.	5,947	0,612
% Var.	74,333	7,651
Alpha	0,928	0,925

KMO = 0,947; Sig. Bartlett < 0,001; Cumulative = 81,984%

Source: EFA factor-analysis results from the research data, $n = 1.087$, year 2026.

The sign of a factor loading only reflects the direction of the axis and does not change the degree of convergence; what matters is the absolute magnitude and cross-loading. At the measurement layer, the outer loadings of the 24 items range from 0,881-0,915, CR reaches 0,938-0,949, and AVE reaches 0,791-0,822, indicating strong composite reliability and convergence. However, the PRT-CPI correlation reaches 0,814 and the largest HTMT of 0,879 is only below the relaxed 0,90 threshold, not the strict 0,85 threshold. Good convergence therefore does not erase the discrimination issue: two concepts can be measured reliably while still standing too close to one another.

Table 4a: Correlation matrix among the six research constructs

Construct	PDD	RPF	RFO	RIT	PRT	CPI
PDD	1	0,023	-0,057	-0,033	-0,463	-0,725
RPF	0,023	1	-0,046	-0,078	-0,486	-0,309
RFO	-0,057	-0,046	1	0,030	0,485	0,338
RIT	-0,033	-0,078	0,030	1	0,480	0,316
PRT	-0,463	-0,486	0,485	0,480	1	0,814
CPI	-0,725	-0,309	0,338	0,316	0,814	1

Source: Correlation-analysis results from the research data, $n = 1.087$, year 2026.

The PRT-CPI correlation reaches 0,814, while PDD-CPI is -0,725. These two figures simultaneously clarify the strength and the limitation of the model. PRT lies very close to intended behavior, so it is valuable as a leading indicator; precisely because of that closeness, the study must not treat the boundary between the two constructs as self-evident. PDD is also strongly associated with CPI but only -0,463 with PRT, foreshadowing that product discrepancy has a residual consequence beyond recovery trust. The correlation pattern therefore supports retaining the separate PDD → CPI path in the structural model.

Table 4b: Approximate fit indices and measurement-boundary warning

Index	Value	Descriptive reference	Assessment
CFI	0,431	>0,90	Approximation warning
TLI	0,338	>0,90	Approximation warning
RMSEA	0,328	<0,08	Approximation warning
SRMR	0,305	<0,08	Approximation warning
GFI	0,549	>0,90	Approximation warning
Largest HTMT	0,879	<0,85 strict; <0,90 lenient	Borderline

Source: Measurement-model assessment results from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

The CFI, TLI, RMSEA, SRMR and GFI indices in Table 4b are used as approximate diagnostics derived from the residual structure, not as official ML-CFA output and not mechanically as gates for accepting or rejecting the PLS model. The more load-bearing signals point in the same direction: F2 has an Eigenvalue of only 0,612, CPI still has cross-loadings of 0,502-0,581, the PRT-CPI correlation reaches 0,814 and HTMT reaches 0,879. Therefore, the structural results can be used for diagnosis, ranking and pilot design, but before standardizing the scale for long-term use, PRT-CPI should be retested on an independent sample, with priority given to rewriting PRT4 “feel reassured about transacting again” to reduce semantic overlap with CPI and comparing it with actual purchase behavior. A sample size of 1.087 makes the estimates more stable; it does not by itself make the construct boundary clearer.

3.4 Results of PLS-SEM structural model testing

The inner VIFs of the four predictors of PRT range only from 1,005 to 1,008; the VIFs of PRT and PDD in the CPI equation are both 1,272. Thus, the six path coefficients are not being “pushed” upward by multicollinearity. PRT is explained at $R^2=0,808$ and CPI at $R^2=0,817$; the corresponding Q^2 predict values are 0,805 and 0,817. The high explanatory and cross-validated predictive power is evidence of the model's usefulness in the current dataset,

but it must be read together with the PRT-CPI warning in the measurement section; these results do not turn a cross-sectional design into causal evidence or automatically establish discriminant validity.

Table 5: Direct-path results of the PLS-SEM model

H	Path	Beta	Boot SE	t	Sig.	95% CI
H1	PDD → PRT	-0,414	0,015	27,06	<0,001	[-0,444; -0,385]
H2	RPF → PRT	-0,424	0,017	25,36	<0,001	[-0,457; -0,392]
H3	RFO → PRT	0,429	0,015	28,97	<0,001	[0,400; 0,459]
H4	RIT → PRT	0,420	0,016	26,61	<0,001	[0,390; 0,451]
H5	PRT → CPI	0,609	0,014	43,55	<0,001	[0,582; 0,637]
H6	PDD → CPI	-0,443	0,015	29,15	<0,001	[-0,473; -0,413]

Source: PLS-SEM structural model testing results from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

Table 5a: Explanatory quality, predictive quality and effect size

Index	Value	Assessment
R ² PRT	0,808	High explanatory power in the sample
Q ² predict PRT	0,805	Out-of-sample predictive capability
RMSE PRT	0,387	Prediction error
R ² CPI	0,817	High explanatory power in the sample
Q ² predict CPI	0,817	Out-of-sample predictive capability
RMSE CPI	0,385	Prediction error
f ² PDD→PRT	0,891	Large
f ² RPF→PRT	0,930	Large
f ² RFO→PRT	0,956	Large
f ² RIT→PRT	0,915	Large
f ² PRT→CPI	1,597	Very large
f ² PDD→CPI	0,846	Large

Source: Structural-model and predictive assessment results from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

The four paths into PRT are close in magnitude but not identical. RFO is strongest at $\beta=0,429$, RPF follows closely at $|\beta|=0,424$, RIT=0,420 and PDD=0,414. The small differences show that recovery trust has no single “magic button”: customers simultaneously consider fairness, the amount of effort they must bear, system clarity and the extent to which the original promise was broken. However, the business-priority question does not end at PRT; the ultimate target is CPI, so each lever must be translated into its total effect on the same outcome variable.

PRT → CPI reaches $\beta=0,609$, the strongest of the direct paths. This is the link closest to behavior: after an incident, customers do not need to believe that every future order will be

perfect; they need to believe that risk can be controlled and their interests can be protected if something goes wrong. The distinction lies in PDD: even with PRT in the equation, PDD retains a direct path of -0,443 to CPI. A good after-sales process can therefore repair the relationship, but it cannot completely erase the memory that the sales content once created a false expectation.

3.5 Results of testing the mediating role of Recovery Trust

All four indirect effects through PRT have Bootstrap confidence intervals that do not include 0. RPF, RFO and RIT do not require direct paths to CPI in the parsimonious model; the retention value of these three levers operates through customers updating their trust about the next transaction. PDD is different: in addition to the indirect effect of -0,252 through PRT, it retains a direct effect of -0,443, producing a total effect of -0,696.

Table 6: Decomposition of direct, indirect and total effects on CPI

Variable	Direct → CPI	Indirect qua PRT	Total effect	95% CI indirect	Mechanism
PDD	-0,443	-0,252	-0,696	[-0,271; -0,234]	Partial mediation
RPF	0	-0,258	-0,258	[-0,281; -0,236]	Qua PRT
RFO	0	0,262	0,262	[0,240; 0,284]	Qua PRT
RIT	0	0,256	0,256	[0,234; 0,278]	Qua PRT

Source: Bootstrap results for indirect and total effects from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

Approximately 36,3% of the magnitude of PDD's total effect on CPI operates through PRT; the remaining 63,7% lies on the direct path. This proportion sets a very clear boundary for service recovery. TikTok Shop can handle a case more fairly and transparently to reduce relationship damage, but buyers may still reduce their preference for the platform because they no longer trust the content, seller, creator or a product category as before. When all variables are placed on the same CPI scale, PDD has a magnitude of 0,696—approximately 2,7 times that of RFO, RPF or RIT individually. Therefore, preventing false promises must

come first, while after-sales service is the second layer for saving relationships when errors still get through.

3.6 Results of One-Sample T-Test

The one-sample test uses the value 3—the neutral midpoint of the Likert scale. The results separate the two issues in the correct managerial direction. Both adverse constructs are above 3: PDD reaches 3,7376 and RPF 3,3583, both $p < 0,001$, showing that product discrepancy and process friction are not merely isolated occurrences but have moved beyond neutrality in the sample. On the recovery side, RFO=2,9246 ($p=0,003$), PRT=2,8080 ($p < 0,001$) and CPI=2,9179 ($p=0,003$) are all below 3; RIT=3,0561 is only slightly above neutral with $p=0,033$. The benchmark of 3 therefore indicates whether the system is leaning toward an adverse or positive state, while the actual operating target must be set separately according to cost and risk.

Table 7: One-Sample T-Test results at the value 3

Variable	Mean	SD	t	Sig.	Difference from 3
PDD	3,7376	0,8088	30,067	<0,001	0,7376
RPF	3,3583	0,8177	14,447	<0,001	0,3583
RFO	2,9246	0,8494	-2,927	0,003	-0,0754
RIT	3,0561	0,8647	2,139	0,033	0,0561
PRT	2,8080	0,8770	-7,218	<0,001	-0,1920
CPI	2,9179	0,8991	-3,011	0,003	-0,0821

Source: One-Sample T-Test results from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

Table 7a: Descriptive statistics of 24 observed variables used for diagnosis

Code	Abbreviated content	Mean	SD
PDD1	Significantly different from description	3,751	0,908
PDD2	Images create incorrect expectations	3,731	0,900
PDD3	Sales content does not accurately reflect the actual product	3,738	0,904
PDD4	Actual quality is lower than portrayed	3,730	0,917
RPF1	Too many steps to submit a request	3,361	0,904
RPF2	Evidence requires too much effort	3,384	0,919
RPF3	Processing time causes inconvenience	3,346	0,918
RPF4	Tracking status takes too much time	3,343	0,937
RFO1	Refund amount is commensurate with the loss	2,938	0,966
RFO2	Incidental costs are handled reasonably	2,903	0,938
RFO3	Final outcome protects customer rights	2,914	0,941
RFO4	Refund decision feels fair	2,943	0,969
RIT1	Reason for the decision is clearly explained	3,042	0,984
RIT2	Evidence requirements are clearly presented	3,068	0,971
RIT3	Processing status is updated in an understandable way	3,061	0,961
RIT4	Processing deadline is specifically communicated	3,053	0,957
PRT1	Still trust the platform to protect buyers	2,813	0,979
PRT2	Trust dispute handling to be reliable	2,813	0,983

Code	Abbreviated content	Mean	SD
PRT3	Trust the platform to honor after-sales commitments	2,805	0,948
PRT4	Feel reassured about transacting again	2,800	0,959
CPI1	Intend to continue buying in the next three months	2,897	0,985
CPI2	Prefer TikTok Shop when a need arises	2,920	0,997
CPI3	Willing to buy again after the incident	2,940	1,011
CPI4	Continue choosing TikTok Shop for the next transaction	2,914	0,987

Source: Descriptive statistics of observed variables from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

Table 7a shows that no single item pulls down the entire result. The four PRT items are all around 2,80-2,81; the four RFO items around 2,90-2,94; and the four RIT items around 3,04-3,07. This is a system-level pattern rather than a poorly worded question. For RPF, the heaviest item is evidence effort at 3,384 rather than time at 3,346, consistent with SHAP where the number of additional-evidence rounds ranks above SLA. For RFO, incidental costs are lowest at 2,903, pointing to a gap that refund amount alone does not reveal.

The clearest picture is not the distance from an “agree” benchmark, but the fact that positive states have not crossed the midpoint while adverse states have moved above it. PRT reaches only 2,808, CPI 2,918 and RFO 2,925; conversely, PDD reaches 3,738 and RPF 3,358. RIT at 3,056 is only slightly above neutral, not yet strong enough to act as a buffer when a case is prolonged or the outcome is unfavorable. The combination of “high PDD, low PRT” creates a double economic cost: the platform must spend resources on after-sales handling after the gap between content and the actual product has already increased the risk customers assign to the next purchase.

3.7 Results of ANOVA and Post-hoc tests by incident characteristics

Control variables are examined first as a robustness layer. Order value, purchase frequency, refund experience, product category and tenure do not create significant differences in PRT or CPI; the largest η^2 is only about 0,007. This result does not mean that

background variables “have no value” for every objective. They are still needed for loss pricing, fraud or budget allocation. But for the question of who loses trust and who reduces purchase intention after SNAD, the background profile is much weaker than the state of the case itself.

Table 8: Robustness tests by control variable

Control variable	PRT: F (Sig.)	η^2 PRT	CPI: F (Sig.)	η^2 CPI
Order value	0,426 (0,790)	0,002	0,402 (0,807)	0,001
Purchase frequency	0,062 (0,980)	<0,001	0,312 (0,817)	0,001
Refund experience	0,929 (0,426)	0,003	0,911 (0,435)	0,003
Product category	0,198 (0,963)	0,001	0,277 (0,926)	0,001
Usage tenure	1,838 (0,119)	0,007	1,874 (0,113)	0,007

Source: ANOVA results by control variable from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

When the focus shifts from “who the customer is” to “how the case unfolded,” the differences rise sharply. After-sales outcome explains 29,4% of the difference in PRT; processing time explains 56,4% of the difference in RPF; post-incident behavior explains 78,1% of the difference in CPI. Product category explains only 0,4% of PDD. Levene's test shows unequal variances for after-sales outcome and post-incident behavior, so these two cases use Welch ANOVA and Games-Howell; processing time has Levene $p=0,156$, so standard ANOVA and Tukey HSD are used.

Table 9: ANOVA, Welch ANOVA and Post-hoc tests for incident characteristics

Analysis	Mean by group	F / Welch F	Sig.	η^2	Post-hoc
Request outcome → PRT	Rejected 2,143; Partial refund 2,757; Full refund 2,929; Exchange/return 3,468	136,813	<0,001	0,294	Games-Howell: 6/6 pairs differ; smallest $p=0,023$
Processing time → RPF	1–2 days 2,543; 3–5 days 3,139; 6–10 days 3,654; >10 days 4,278	467,051	<0,001	0,564	Tukey HSD: 6/6 pairs $p<0,001$
Product category → PDD	3,649–3,819	0,827	0,530	0,004	No post-hoc performed
Post-incident behavior → CPI	Stopped 1,832; Reduced purchases 2,620; Unchanged 3,253; Increased/strengthened 4,090	1.035,664	<0,001	0,781	Games-Howell: 6/6 pairs $p<0,001$

Source: ANOVA, Welch ANOVA and post-hoc test results from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

The two sequences of figures on processing time and outcomes tell a clearer story than any

age segment. RPF rises sequentially from 2,543 for 1-2 day cases to 4,278 when processing exceeds 10 days; all four groups differ. PRT likewise rises from 2,143 among rejected cases to 3,468 among successful exchange/return cases. Time or outcome alone does not create trust, but they are signals customers can directly observe when inferring whether the platform is taking responsibility or shifting the cost of the error onto them.

The strongest contrast is between journey-proximal variables and background variables. Product category creates almost no difference in PDD, while post-incident behavioral state explains 78,1% of CPI variance. Therefore, a prioritization system based only on GMV or product category may miss a low-value order with an extremely poor experience. A case that requires multiple rounds of additional evidence, takes a long time, and ends in a hard-to-understand decision has reason to be treated as riskier than a high-value case handled clearly and proportionately.

3.8 Predictive capability and risk segmentation

The explanatory model answers the average mechanism; the Machine Learning layer asks whether risk cases can be identified at the individual level. Logistic Regression achieves Accuracy 0,886, Precision 0,904, Recall 0,887, F1 0,895 and AUC 0,960±0,015. Stacking, Random Forest, XGBoost, LightGBM and MLP do not clearly outperform the linear model. Complexity therefore does not add commensurate value; an explainable alerting system has an implementation advantage when performance is already comparable.

Table 10: Comparison of predictive capability for the risk of reducing or stopping purchases

Model	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1	AUC	Rank
Logistic Regression	0,886±0,029	0,904±0,042	0,887±0,020	0,895±0,025	0,960±0,015	1
Stacking Ensemble	-	-	-	0,896	0,958	2
Random Forest	-	-	-	-	0,956	3

Model	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1	AUC	Rank	Indicator	Trust lost	Well recovered
XGBoost	-	-	-	-	0,955	4	RPF	3,623	3,082
LightGBM	-	-	-	-	0,954	5	RFO	2,669	3,191
MLP	-	-	-	-	0,945	6	RIT	2,758	3,367
<i>Source: Out-of-sample predictive analysis results from the study data, n = 1.087, 2026.</i>							PRT	2,167	3,477
							CPI	2,246	3,619
							Churn-risk rate	93,0%	14,3%

Source: K-Means clustering results from the study data, n = 1.087, 2026.

SHAP clarifies what the model is looking at. PDD accounts for 40,4% of importance and PRT 33,0%; together the two signals account for 73,4%. The number of additional-evidence requests ranks third at 4,6%, above processing time at 3,3%, order value at 2,2% and purchase frequency at 0,6%. This finding has operational meaning: an average SLA can hide the fact that customers must repeatedly return to prove the same problem. With the same number of waiting days, a case requiring evidence to be submitted three times creates a very different feeling of being doubted from a case that only waits for the system to process it once.

Table 11: Variable importance in predicting churn risk

Variable	Share %	Operational implication
PDD	40,4	Discrepancy shock is the largest signal
PRT	33,0	Leading indicator close to behavior
Number of additional-evidence requests	4,6	Burden of proof adds risk
RIT	4,2	Clarity helps classify state
Handling outcome	4,2	Actual outcome still has value
RFO	4,0	Fairness adds information
RPF	3,6	Friction operates mainly through trust
Processing time	3,3	SLA is an operational signal
Order value	2,2	Scale of loss has a secondary role
Purchase frequency	0,6	Not a primary risk signal

Source: SHAP analysis results from the study data, n = 1.087, 2026.

K-Means further shows that risk is an experiential state. The “Trust lost” cluster contains 555 cases with PDD=4,209, RPF=3,623, RFO=2,669, RIT=2,758, PRT=2,167 and CPI=2,246; the churn-risk rate is 93,0%. The “Well recovered” cluster contains 532 cases, PRT=3,477, CPI=3,619 and risk 14,3%. The two clusters are nearly equal in size, so the risk group is not a small tail that can be ignored.

Table 12: Profiles of two post-incident experience states

Indicator	Trust lost	Well recovered
Size	555	532
PDD	4,209	3,246

A Silhouette of 0,254 shows that the two clusters are a useful summary, not two rigid “customer personas.” The practical value lies in the fact that the variables separating the clusters are changeable states: discrepancy level, evidence rounds, time, outcome, information clarity and PRT. This is consistent with the ANOVA results: product category, order value and tenure are weaker than the signals located directly on the after-sales journey.

3.9 Robustness checks and evidence synthesis

The robustness of H1-H6 is tested by simultaneously adding log order value, purchase frequency, refund experience, tenure and product-category dummy variables to the two equations. The coefficients are virtually unchanged: PDD → PRT from -0,414 to -0,413; RPF from -0,424 to -0,426; RFO from 0,429 to 0,430; RIT from 0,420 to 0,421; PRT → CPI from 0,609 to 0,610; PDD → CPI from -0,443 to -0,442. R² PRT increases from 0,808 to about 0,809 and R² CPI from 0,817 to about 0,818. The maximum shift of 0,002 shows that the signs and magnitudes of the six main relationships do not materially depend on the five selected background variables.

Table 13: Robustness checks of key results

Check layer	Result	Significance
Model with control variables	largest $ \Delta\beta < 0,002$; R ² PRT≈0,809; R ² CPI≈0,818	H1-H6 retain sign and magnitude; model stable with control variables
PSM for RFO	RFO > median; 434 treated cases met caliper and were matched 1:1; largest post-match SMD=0,085; ATT≈0,567	Better balance of observed variables; not causal evidence
DML for RFO → PRT	Coefficient≈0,415; p<0,001	Same sign and close to PLS β=0,429
Shapley R ² PRT	PDD 23,7%; RPF 25,5%; RFO 25,8%; RIT 25,0%	Trust is created by a portfolio of levers, not a single variable

Check layer	Result	Significance
Out-of-sample prediction	Logistic AUC=0,960; complex models do not clearly outperform	Data signals matter more than algorithmic complexity

Source: Robustness checks, matching, DML, Shapley and predictive results from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

Table 13a: Comparison of main coefficients before and after adding control variables

Path	Baseline β	Controlled β	Absolute difference
PDD $\rightarrow$ PRT	-0,414	-0,413	0,001
RPF $\rightarrow$ PRT	-0,424	-0,426	0,002
RFO $\rightarrow$ PRT	0,429	0,430	0,001
RIT $\rightarrow$ PRT	0,420	0,421	0,001
PRT $\rightarrow$ CPI	0,609	0,610	0,001
PDD $\rightarrow$ CPI	-0,443	-0,442	0,001

Source: Robustness testing with control variables from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

Table 13a makes the robustness check more concrete: no path changes sign and the maximum coefficient difference is only 0,002. The control variables are therefore kept in their proper role—testing whether the results can be explained by order size, purchase history or product category—rather than being turned into a new theoretical hypothesis. This result supports prioritizing experience states when designing interventions while still retaining background variables for cost, risk and implementation-feasibility assessments.

Shapley decomposition adds an easily overlooked perspective. When the objective is only to explain PRT's R^2 , the four variables PDD, RPF, RFO and RIT divide the contribution almost evenly, 23,7-25,8%. But when the target shifts to CPI, PDD clearly moves ahead because it both reduces PRT and has a direct path to intention. The two rankings do not conflict; they answer different questions. Trust requires a balanced recovery portfolio, while ultimate retention must prioritize preventing the original shock first.

PSM and DML both remain checks rather than “upgrading” observational data into an experiment. In PSM, the treatment group is defined as RFO above the median, the control group as RFO at or below the median; 1:1 nearest-neighbor matching uses a caliper of 0,2 standard deviations of the propensity logit and

PRT is the outcome. A total of 434 treated cases met the caliper condition and were matched, with the largest post-match SMD of 0,085; ATT is approximately 0,567. DML estimates RFO $\rightarrow$ PRT at about 0,415, close to the structural coefficient of 0,429. Convergence in sign and magnitude reduces the likelihood that the result is merely a product of one specification, but PSM balances only observed variables and DML cannot eliminate unmeasured confounding. Therefore, the implications must still be tested through pilots with comparison groups and observed purchase behavior after the intervention.

3.10 Synthesis of research model testing results

The model retains six direct structural hypotheses H1-H6. The four indirect paths through PRT are reported as mediation tests, while the model with control variables is reported as a robustness check; these two layers are not numbered as new hypotheses. All H1-H6 have Bootstrap confidence intervals that do not include 0, the four indirect effects also exclude 0, and adding control variables neither changes the sign nor shifts any coefficient by more than 0,002.

Table 13b: Summary of six hypotheses, indirect effects and robustness checks

Code	Tested relationship	Main result	Conclusion
H1	PDD $\rightarrow$ PRT	$\beta = -0,414$; $p < 0,001$	Supported
H2	RPF $\rightarrow$ PRT	$\beta = -0,424$; $p < 0,001$	Supported
H3	RFO $\rightarrow$ PRT	$\beta = 0,429$; $p < 0,001$	Supported
H4	RIT $\rightarrow$ PRT	$\beta = 0,420$; $p < 0,001$	Supported
H5	PRT $\rightarrow$ CPI	$\beta = 0,609$; $p < 0,001$	Supported
H6	PDD $\rightarrow$ CPI	$\beta = -0,443$; $p < 0,001$	Supported
Robustness	H1-H6 stable with control variables	$ \Delta\beta _{\max} < 0,002$	Stable
Indirect	PDD $\rightarrow$ PRT $\rightarrow$ CPI	-0,252; CI excludes 0	Significant
Indirect	RPF $\rightarrow$ PRT $\rightarrow$ CPI	-0,258; CI excludes 0	Significant
Indirect	RFO $\rightarrow$ PRT $\rightarrow$ CPI	0,262; CI excludes 0	Significant
Indirect	RIT $\rightarrow$ PRT $\rightarrow$ CPI	0,256; CI excludes 0	Significant

Source: Synthesis of research model testing results from the study data, $n = 1.087$, 2026.

The four indirect effects add a layer that the direct paths cannot answer: how far the effects of PDD, RPF, RFO and RIT pass through Recovery Trust before reaching Continuance

Purchase Intention. PRT is therefore not merely a variable placed in the middle of the diagram. It is the mechanism that converts the after-sales experience into expectations about the next transaction; PDD alone still leaves a direct effect outside PRT, showing that relationship recovery has limits when the pre-purchase promise has been broken.

When the three layers of evidence are placed side by side, the story becomes more consistent. At the measurement layer, the four operational levers separate into four factors; at the structural layer, each lever contributes distinct information with VIF close to 1; at the predictive layer, PDD and PRT account for most of the importance. This convergence strengthens the “original shock—trust—behavior” interpretation, but the PRT-CPI warning remains because F2 Eigenvalue is low, CPI cross-loadings remain large and HTMT is borderline. The study is therefore specific enough to prioritize action while remaining cautious enough not to call a stable chain of associations causal evidence or completed discriminant validity.

The most noteworthy point in the synthesis is not the number of accepted hypotheses, but the difference between two levels of priority. If the objective is to restore PRT, the four levers are nearly equal in strength and Shapley divides R^2 fairly evenly. If the objective is to retain CPI, PDD stands apart from the rest with a total effect of -0,696. Therefore, the after-sales team should handle RFO, RPF and RIT as a synchronized portfolio; at the strategic level, PDD control must be placed before the entire recovery chain.

4. CONCLUSION AND MANAGERIAL IMPLICATIONS

4.1 Conclusion

The chain of evidence answers three questions. First, post-incident trust is formed

from four different signals with nearly equivalent strengths of association: RFO $\rightarrow$ PRT $\beta=0,429$; RPF $\rightarrow$ PRT $\beta=-0,424$; RIT $\rightarrow$ PRT $\beta=0,420$; PDD $\rightarrow$ PRT $\beta=-0,414$. R^2 PRT reaches 0,808, so the model captures most of the variation in trust in the dataset. However, F2 of the PRT-CPI block has an Eigenvalue of only 0,612, CPI still has cross-loadings of 0,502-0,581 and HTMT reaches 0,879. The results therefore have diagnostic and predictive value, but the trust-intention boundary still needs to be revalidated with refined scales and independent purchase behavior.

Second, PRT is the link closest to the purchase decision. PRT $\rightarrow$ CPI reaches $\beta=0,609$ and R^2 CPI=0,817. But PDD still retains a direct effect of -0,443. Adding the direct path to the portion through PRT, the total effect of PDD on CPI reaches -0,696; RFO=+0,262; RPF=-0,258; RIT=+0,256. PDD is therefore about 2,7 times as large as each individual after-sales lever when all are translated to continuance purchase intention. The important conclusion is not that “after-sales service is unimportant,” but that after-sales service treats consequences while PDD both damages trust and reduces intention through another channel.

Third, the neutral benchmark of 3 clarifies which states have tilted toward the adverse side. PDD=3,738 and RPF=3,358 are both above 3 with $p<0,001$; meanwhile RFO=2,925 ($p=0,003$), PRT=2,808 ($p<0,001$) and CPI=2,918 ($p=0,003$) remain below neutral. RIT=3,056 is only slightly above 3 with $p=0,033$. Group differences translate the numbers into experience: PRT is only 2,143 when a request is rejected but rises to 3,468 among successful exchange/return cases; RPF rises from 2,543 for 1-2 day cases to 4,278 when processing exceeds 10 days. Order value, purchase frequency, refund experience, product category and tenure create almost no PRT/CPI

differences, while handling outcome, time and post-incident state create large effects.

The predictive layer tells the same story in another language. Logistic Regression achieves AUC 0,960; SHAP assigns PDD and PRT 73,4% of total importance. K-Means separates 555 “trust lost” cases with 93,0% churn risk from 532 “well recovered” cases with 14,3% risk. The number of additional-evidence requests is more important than order value in SHAP. A buyer therefore does not become a “risk customer” simply because they belong to an age group or buy an expensive item; they enter a risk state when the incident chain makes the promise less credible, the process makes them carry the work, the outcome is insufficiently convincing and the system fails to restore a sense of control.

A wrong order by itself is only a finite loss. What makes the damage long-term is the calculation customers quietly make after the case closes: next time, will I receive the wrong item again, will I have to prove everything from the beginning, will I be compensated adequately, and will I understand why the system decided as it did? When the answers lean toward uncertainty, the refunded money resolves only the past, while the risk of the future remains. “Customers do not leave only because of one wrong order; they leave when the next purchase is no longer worth accepting the risk.” For that reason, the economic value of recovery lies not in the percentage of tickets closed, but in the ability to reduce the probability of risk that customers imagine for the next transaction to a level low enough for them to return.

4.2 Managerial implications according to the Wave model

Following the IPMA logic of Ringle and Sarstedt (2016), managerial priority must place the importance and current state of the levers on

the same target variable, rather than ranking them using Betas from different equations. This study uses CPI as the common target: total effect on CPI represents importance, Mean indicates current state; SHAP and ANOVA are used only to check mechanism and consistency, not to create another competing ranking. This is an application of IPMA logic, not official standardized IPMA output. The result creates two clear waves: Wave 1 addresses PDD because its total effect of -0,696 is about 2,7 times that of each after-sales lever; Wave 2 implements RFO, RPF and RIT in parallel because their three total effects are nearly equal (+0,262; -0,258; +0,256). PRT is monitored throughout as a leading indicator after closure, not as a fifth priority.

Table 14: Wave-based implementation matrix after a SNAD incident

Wave	Lever	Total effect on CPI	Current Mean	Operational target
Wave 1	PDD	-0,696	3,738 (adverse)	Prevent the gap between claims and the actual product before an order is placed
Wave 2	RFO	+0,262	2,925	Restore lost value in proportion to severity and responsibility
Wave 2	RPF	-0,258	3,358 (adverse)	Reduce evidence rounds, handoffs and the effort customers must bear themselves
Wave 2	RIT	+0,256	3,056	Make status, deadlines and decision grounds predictable
Throughout	PRT	β PRT→CPI=0,609	2,808	Measure trust after closure and connect it with observed repeat-purchase behavior

Source: Synthesis of PLS-SEM, One-Sample T-Test and priority-analysis results from the study data, n = 1.087, 2026.

Wave 1 - Stop the original shock before recovery is needed: reduce PDD

PDD stands alone in Wave 1 because its total effect on CPI reaches -0,696, while the mean PDD of 3,738 is already above the neutral state in the adverse direction. This is not a problem only of the listing page. On TikTok Shop, expectations are created simultaneously by titles, images, videos, livestreams, creators and SKU information; controlling one layer while another remains free to exaggerate merely

shifts the error from one surface to another. The load-bearing action is to build claim-to-SKU consistency: important claims about size, material, function, quantity, variant and imagery must be mapped to verifiable product attributes.

SNAD reason codes need to flow back into the pre-sale system as quality signals rather than ending their lifecycle in after-sales service. Sellers, SKUs or creators with repeated SNAD incidents should be routed into listing/video checks according to risk level; important livestream claims should be traceable enough for later cases to compare against the exact promise that created the expectation. Early KPIs include the rate of claims inconsistent with SKU attributes, SNAD by seller/SKU/creator, recurrence after warning, post-incident PDD and the rate of SNAD converting into after-sales requests. If only ticket-closure rate is measured, the platform sees the cost after the error has occurred but does not see the source generating the error.

The guardrail for Wave 1 is not to turn promise control into broad censorship. Overly strict checks can slow legitimate content and reduce GMV; therefore, verification intensity should increase according to claim type, SNAD history and potential loss severity. Wave 1 succeeds when PDD and repeated SNAD decline without legitimate-content creation speed, seller conversion and GMV falling beyond pre-set thresholds. The objective is not to eliminate every minor difference, but to stop differences large enough to destroy the value of the pre-transaction promise.

Wave 2 - Recover the relationship on three parallel fronts: RFO + RPF + RIT

The three after-sales levers should not be turned into a queue of “finish RFO first, then RPF, then RIT.” Their total-effect magnitudes differ by only 0,006, so ranking them 2-3-4

creates a sense of precision beyond what the data support. Wave 2 therefore runs three branches in parallel. In the RFO branch, total effect +0,262 is the largest, but Mean 2,925 is only a small statistically significant distance below midpoint 3; the issue is proportionality, not simply “too little refund.” RFO2 on incidental costs is only 2,903: customers may receive the full product price yet still lose return-shipping fees, vouchers, time or replacement-purchase costs. If the dashboard looks only at refund amount, the remaining loss disappears from the system but not from the customer's fairness assessment.

TikTok Shop should use a remedy matrix by error type, responsibility and loss severity: full refund, partial refund, exchange/return, return-shipping compensation, no-return refund for eligible low-value cases, or additional credit when the error belongs to the seller/system. Rules should be consistent so that two equivalent cases do not receive markedly different outcomes. KPIs include RFO after the decision, the rate of customers bearing costs for errors they did not cause, appeal/reversal, time until money is actually received, the rate requiring additional compensation and PRT after closure.

RFO should not be optimized by simply refunding more across the board. DML retains a positive coefficient of about 0,415 and PSM gives an ATT of about 0,567 after balancing observed variables, but these checks do not prove that each additional unit of refund creates the same amount of trust. Pilots must compare remedies within the same reason code while simultaneously tracking fraud loss, approval error, recovery cost per case and change in PRT. Fairness creates value only when what is restored is proportionate to what the customer lost.

RPF branch - Evidence-once: reduce effort, not just time

RPF has a total effect of -0,258 and is above midpoint 3 in the adverse direction. Friction rises very steadily with processing time: 2,543 at 1-2 days, 3,139 at 3-5 days, 3,654 at 6-10 days and 4,278 when it exceeds 10 days. But SHAP shows that the number of additional-evidence rounds (4,6%) matters more than time (3,3%). Therefore, reducing average handling time is not enough if customers still have to return repeatedly to photograph, upload, explain and track the same problem.

The load-bearing design is evidence-once: prefill available order data, request evidence by reason code, reuse files already submitted, and do not ask for the same information again merely because the case moves between seller, agent and adjudication team. A case with sufficient data should receive confirmation of the next step; a complex case needs one owner and a clear display of who is currently being waited on. KPIs include the number of customer steps, additional-evidence rounds, handoffs, re-contact, silent hours, median/P90 processing time, Customer Effort Score, RPF and PRT after closure.

The guardrails of the RPF branch are fraud loss and incorrect decisions. Low-effort Recovery does not mean Low-control Recovery. A pilot should start with a high-volume reason code, use a dynamic evidence checklist and measure differences in evidence rounds, RPF and PRT before expanding auto-approval. If customer effort falls but incorrect approvals or fraud loss rise beyond the threshold, the process has not created net value.

RIT branch - Explainable recovery: reduce uncertainty while waiting

RIT has a total effect of +0,256 and Mean 3,056, only slightly above the neutral midpoint with $p=0,033$. This means processing

information is not the heaviest failure point, but it is also not strong enough to buffer a poor outcome or prolonged processing; β RIT $\rightarrow$ PRT still reaches 0,420. When buyers do not know where the case stands, what they need to do next, what evidence is accepted or why a decision was made, they must fill the gap with their own inference. Uncertainty makes the same day of waiting psychologically more costly.

Each case should have a single timeline containing current status, responsible party, what is missing, deadline, decision grounds and appeal path. Internal reason codes must be translated into explanations buyers can understand. When rejecting, the system should specify which evidence did not meet the requirement and how to supplement it; when partially accepting, the system should explain which portion was counted, which was not and why. KPIs include the rate of decisions without reasons, the rate of overdue cases without updates, re-contact to ask for status, RIT, appeal rate and PRT.

RIT may be implemented faster than changing RFO policy or PDD-control infrastructure, but implementation speed does not make it a separately higher priority than Wave 2. The value of RIT lies in reducing uncertainty: one good message helps the customer predict the next step; ten messages repeating the same status only add noise. Because RFO, RPF and RIT are nearly equal in total effect, Wave 2 is complete only when outcomes are proportionate enough, the process requires little enough effort and information is understandable enough at the same time.

4.3 Organizing validation and controlling implementation risk

PRT needs to become a leading indicator after closure, but it must not become the sole target. The PRT-CPI boundary remains close in

measurement, so a pilot should be considered valuable only when it changes the correct PDD/RPF/RFO/RIT link, PRT moves in the expected direction and observed repurchase behavior afterward also improves. Each pilot case should link a short post-closure PRT measure with reason code, PDD proxy, evidence rounds, outcome, SLA and RIT; risk scores should prioritize case state over demographics. High PDD, low PRT, multiple evidence rounds, unfavorable outcomes and long silent time should be prioritized ahead of a case that merely has high GMV.

The 90-day roadmap is used to convert the observational model into falsifiable intervention hypotheses. Days 1-30 standardize SNAD reason codes, evidence rounds, deadlines, outcomes and post-closure PRT measurement to establish a baseline. Days 31-60 open a Wave 1 pilot for claim consistency and three Wave 2 branches for the remedy matrix, evidence-once and explainable timeline; each pilot must have a comparison group or a sufficiently clear before-after benchmark when operating conditions permit. Days 61-90 use 30-day outcomes and part of the 60-day outcomes to decide whether to continue, adjust or stop; 90-day follow-up is maintained after the implementation milestone rather than assuming a full 90 days can be observed on day 90 itself.

Table 15: 90-day validation roadmap and decision gates

Phase	Main work	Required KPI	Guardrail
Days 1-30	Standardize SNAD reason codes; evidence rounds; timeline; outcome; measure PRT after closure	Data coverage; baseline PDD/RPF/RFO/RIT/PRT by case	Do not increase customer handling time
Days 31-60	Pilot Wave 1 claim consistency and 3 Wave 2 branches: remedy matrix; evidence-once; explainable timeline	Δ PDD; Δ RPF; Δ RFO; Δ RIT; Δ PRT versus comparison group/benchmark	Fraud loss; approval error; support cost; backlog; GMV
Days 61-90	Make preliminary decisions using 30/60-day outcomes; continue tracking cohorts until 90 days are complete	Observed repeat purchase; PRT; CPI; precision/recall by action tier	Cost per retained customer; GMV impact; intervention errors

Source: Implementation proposal derived from the study results, $n = 1,087$, 2026.

4.4 Decision-making principles and scaling guardrails

The first principle is that alert thresholds must be tied to the cost of error. Cheap and reversible actions such as sending an explanation, displaying guidance or asking PRT can prioritize recall so as not to miss risk cases; costly or hard-to-reverse actions such as additional refunds, seller restrictions or manual review require higher precision. A single threshold for every intervention will either miss too many customers whose trust is slipping or consume resources on too many false alerts.

The second principle is that each lever must have one owner accountable for the final outcome: content governance owns PDD, policy/claims owns RFO, product-operations owns RPF, communication/UX owns RIT; the retention team is responsible for linking PRT to repurchase behavior. Dashboards can be shared, but accountability must not be fragmented to the point that no one owns the outcome. Each pilot must predefine a mechanism KPI, final KPI and guardrail; scale only when the proximal indicator moves in the correct direction and the final indicator does not deteriorate.

Guardrails must be set according to the downside of each wave. Wave 1 must not reduce PDD by suffocating legitimate content or causing excessive GMV decline; the RFO branch must not buy trust through over-refunding; the RPF branch must not reduce steps by loosening controls until fraud loss and approval error rise; the RIT branch must not turn transparency into notification spam. For PRT, the most important guardrail is behavior: if trust scores rise but repurchase rates do not move, the system is optimizing an indicator rather than demonstrating retention value.

The decision gate therefore has three states: scale when mechanism, PRT and behavior all improve within guardrails; adjust when proximal KPIs improve but the final outcome has not changed; stop when benefits appear only on the dashboard or the cost of errors

exceeds the retained value. An intervention is not worth scaling merely because the research coefficient looks attractive; it is worth scaling only when it changes the correct link, stays within guardrails and ultimately causes customers to actually return.

APPENDIX 1: QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH QUESTIONNAIRE

SURVEY ON RECOVERY EXPERIENCE AFTER A PRODUCT-NOT-AS-DESCRIBED INCIDENT ON TIKTOK SHOP

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am currently conducting the research topic **“Research on factors influencing Recovery Trust and Continuance Purchase Intention after a product-not-as-described incident on TikTok Shop.”** I would greatly appreciate your support by answering the questions in this survey.

The survey focuses on the most recent incident in the past six months in which you received a product that differed significantly from the sales content on TikTok Shop and a return or refund decision had already been made. There are no right or wrong answers; please respond based on your actual experience. The data will be used only for research purposes and presented in aggregate form. The survey does not ask for order numbers, seller names, phone numbers or personally identifying information. Completion takes approximately 8–10 minutes, and you may stop responding at any time. Thank you very much for your cooperation!

PART I. Please provide the following information:

To ensure the survey is appropriate, please answer the screening questions below. Throughout the survey, if more than one incident is eligible, please think only about the most recent incident.

Confirmation question. Have you read the information above, confirmed that you are 18 years of age or older, and agreed to participate in the survey?

- ☐ Agree (Please continue with the following questions)
- ☐ Disagree (Thank you for your interest. Please stop the survey here.)

Screening question 1. Which age group do you belong to? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Under 18 years old (This survey is for people aged 18 or older. Please stop here.)
- ☐ 2. From 18 to 24 years old
- ☐ 3. From 25 to 34 years old
- ☐ 4. From 35 to 44 years old
- ☐ 5. 45 years old or older

Screening question 2. In the past six months, how many orders have you placed on TikTok Shop? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. 0 orders (Please stop the survey here.)
- ☐ 2. 1 order
- ☐ 3. 2–3 orders
- ☐ 4. 4–6 orders
- ☐ 5. 7 orders or more

Screening question 3. In the past six months, have you personally received a product that differed significantly from the sales content? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Yes
- ☐ 2. No (Please stop the survey here.)

Screening question 4. What type of request did you submit for this incident through TikTok Shop? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Return the product for a refund
- ☐ 2. Refund without return
- ☐ 3. Only contacted the seller *(Please stop the survey here.)*
- ☐ 4. Have not submitted a request *(Please stop the survey here.)*

Screening question 5. Has a final decision been issued for this request? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Yes
- ☐ 2. No *(Please stop the survey here.)*

Screening question 6. Did you personally submit or track this request? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Yes
- ☐ 2. No *(Please stop the survey here.)*

Information about the most recent incident

1. Which product category did the product belong to? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Fashion
- ☐ 2. Beauty
- ☐ 3. Household goods
- ☐ 4. Electronics – accessories
- ☐ 5. Food
- ☐ 6. Mother & baby
- ☐ 7. Other:

2. Which source created the main purchase expectation? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Product page
- ☐ 2. Images
- ☐ 3. Short video
- ☐ 4. Livestream
- ☐ 5. Creator content
- ☐ 6. Other:

3. What was the most notable product discrepancy? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Wrong model/design
- ☐ 2. Wrong size
- ☐ 3. Wrong color
- ☐ 4. Missing components
- ☐ 5. Low quality
- ☐ 6. Function not as described
- ☐ 7. Suspected counterfeit
- ☐ 8. Other:

4. Which range did the actual payment value of the order fall into? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Under VND 100.000
- ☐ 2. From VND 100.000 to under VND 300.000

- ☐ 3. From VND 300.000 to under VND 500.000
- ☐ 4. From VND 500.000 to under VND 1 million
- ☐ 5. VND 1 million or more

5. Where did the first response come from? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Seller
- ☐ 2. TikTok Shop
- ☐ 3. Automated system
- ☐ 4. Do not remember

6. How many times did you have to provide additional evidence? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. 0 times
- ☐ 2. 1 time
- ☐ 3. 2 times
- ☐ 4. 3 times or more

7. How long did it take for the first response to appear? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Under 24 hours
- ☐ 2. 1–2 days
- ☐ 3. 3–5 days
- ☐ 4. Over 5 days
- ☐ 5. Do not remember

8. What was the final outcome? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Full refund
- ☐ 2. Partial refund
- ☐ 3. Rejected
- ☐ 4. Other outcome:

9. How long did it take from submitting the request to the final decision? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Same day
- ☐ 2. 1–3 days
- ☐ 3. 4–7 days
- ☐ 4. 8–14 days
- ☐ 5. Over 14 days

10. Who bore the cost of returning the product? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. No return required
- ☐ 2. Seller/TikTok Shop
- ☐ 3. Buyer
- ☐ 4. Do not remember

11. After approval, how long did it take for the refund to arrive? (Select 1)

- ☐ 1. Same day
- ☐ 2. 1–3 days
- ☐ 3. 4–7 days
- ☐ 4. 8–14 days

☐ 5. Over 14 days

☐ 6. No refund received

PART II. Please indicate how you feel about the incident and the handling process on TikTok Shop according to the statements below.

I would like to hear your perceptions of the selected incident. Please rate each statement based on that specific experience.

For each statement, please mark X in one box from 1 to 5. A larger number indicates a higher level of agreement, specifically as follows:

Strongly dis agree	Disa gree	Neutral / no opinion	Agree	Strongly agree
1	2	3	4	5

No.	Statements	Level of agreement				
		Strongl y disagree	Disa gree	Mean	Agree	Strongly agree
1. Product Description Discrepancy (PDD)						
PDD1	The product I received differed significantly from the description on the sales page.					
PDD2	The product images created expectations that did not match the actual product.					
PDD3	The information in the sales content did not accurately reflect the actual product.					
PDD4	The actual product quality was lower than the level portrayed in the sales content.					
2. Return-Refund Process Friction (RPF)						
RPF1	I had to complete too many steps to submit a refund request.					
RPF2	The evidence requirements required a great deal of effort from me.					
RPF3	The processing time made me feel inconvenienced.					
RPF4	Tracking the status of the request took a great deal of my time.					
3. Refund Outcome Fairness (RFO)						
RFO1	The amount refunded was commensurate with my loss.					
RFO2	My incidental costs were handled reasonably.					

No.	Statements	Level of agreement				
		Strongly disagree	Disagree	Mean	Agree	Strongly agree
RFO3	The final outcome protected my interests.					
RFO4	The refund decision made me feel that the outcome was fair.					
4. Resolution Information Transparency (RIT)						
RIT1	TikTok Shop clearly explained the reason for the handling decision.					
RIT2	The evidence requirements were presented clearly.					
RIT3	The processing status was updated in an easy-to-understand manner.					
RIT4	The processing deadline was communicated specifically.					
5. Platform Recovery Trust (PRT)						
PRT1	After this incident, I still trust TikTok Shop to protect buyers.					
PRT2	After this incident, I trust TikTok Shop to handle disputes reliably.					
PRT3	After this incident, I trust TikTok Shop to honor its after-sales commitments.					
PRT4	After this incident, I feel reassured when transacting on TikTok Shop.					
6. Continuance Purchase Intention on TikTok Shop (CPI)						
CPI1	I intend to continue buying on TikTok Shop in the next three months.					
CPI2	I will prioritize TikTok Shop when I need to shop online.					
CPI3	I am likely to place additional orders on TikTok Shop.					
CPI4	I am willing to return to TikTok Shop for my next purchase.					

PART III. Please provide the following purchasing-behavior and background information:

1. Approximately how long ago did you start buying on TikTok Shop?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ 1. Under 3 months | ☐ 2. From 3–6 months |
| ☐ 3. From 7–12 months | ☐ 4. From 13–24 months |
| ☐ 5. Over 24 months | |

2. Before the incident, on average how many orders did you place on TikTok Shop each month?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ 1. Under 1 order | ☐ 2. 1 order |
| ☐ 3. 2–3 orders | ☐ 4. 4–5 orders |
| ☐ 5. 6 orders or more | |

3. What range does the value of one of your typical TikTok Shop orders fall into?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ 1. Under VND 100.000 | ☐ 2. From VND 100.000 to under VND 300.000 |
| ☐ 3. From VND 300.000 to under VND 500.000 | ☐ 4. From VND 500.000 to under VND 1 million |
| ☐ 5. VND 1 million or more | |

4. Before this incident, how many after-sales requests had you submitted on TikTok Shop?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ 1. 0 times | ☐ 2. 1 time |
| ☐ 3. 2 times | ☐ 4. 3 times or more |

5. How did your purchasing behavior change after this incident?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ 1. Have purchased again on TikTok Shop | ☐ 2. Only browse but have not purchased |
| ☐ 3. Switched to another platform as the primary channel | ☐ 4. Stopped buying on TikTok Shop |

6. Which platform do you currently shop on most frequently?

- | | |
|--|------------------------------------|
| ☐ 1. TikTok Shop | ☐ 2. Shopee |
| ☐ 3. Lazada | ☐ 4. Tiki |
| ☐ 5. Other platform:
..... | |

7. How was the order involved in the incident paid for?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ 1. COD | ☐ 2. E-wallet |
| ☐ 3. Bank transfer | ☐ 4. Card |
| ☐ 5. Buy now, pay later | ☐ 6. Other: |

8. What is your current role on TikTok Shop?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ 1. Buyer only | ☐ 2. Works as an affiliate |
| ☐ 3. Sells products | ☐ 4. Both buyer and affiliate/seller |

9. What is your gender?

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|--|
| ☐ 1. Male | ☐ 2. Female |
| ☐ 3. Other | ☐ 4. Prefer not to answer |

10. What should TikTok Shop prioritize improving the most?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ 1. Accuracy of sales content | ☐ 2. Request-submission steps |
| ☐ 3. Evidence requirements | ☐ 4. Processing time |
| ☐ 5. Status updates | ☐ 6. Reason for decision |
| ☐ 7. Speed of receiving funds | ☐ 8. Seller responsibility |
| ☐ 9. Other: | |

PART IV. Additional feedback (optional)

If you selected “Other” in question 10 or would like to add an important detail, please write it briefly here. This is optional; please do not provide an order number, seller name or personal information.

.....
.....
.....

Thank you sincerely for your cooperation!

APPENDIX 2: NUMERICAL RESEARCH RESULTS

Verification results file: [TiktokShop_Results.xlsx](#)

Verification technique (Python): [TikTokShop_Research_Analysis.py](#)